PART I · PITCH · TIPS

When a note reads wrong

Most misread notes come from a handful of slips. Name the slip first, then fix only that note: playing the whole line again rarely finds it.

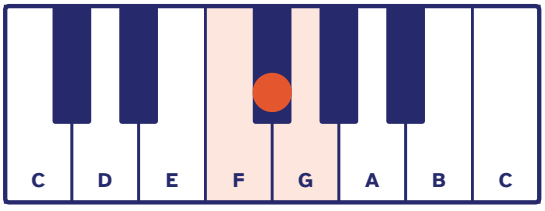
TIP

What you notice, what to check

WHAT YOU NOTICE	CHECK	TURN TO
The left hand reads like the right	**the clef**: bass lines are G B D F A, not E G B D F	p. 25
You land an octave too high or too low	**a landmark**: middle C, treble G or bass F	p. 28
Notes above or below the staff slow you down	**the ledger lines**: count them from the nearest landmark	p. 28
A sharp or flat vanishes, or stays too long	**the bar line**: an accidental lasts only to the end of its bar	p. 34
You play the black key on the wrong side	**the direction**: a sharp goes right (up), a flat goes left (down)	p. 34
Two notes sound too close or too far apart	**the interval**: count the letters, then the keys between	p. 37

EXAMPLE

Same key, two names



1. **From F, go one key right:** the red black key is **F♯**.
2. **From G, go one key left:** you reach the same red key, **G♭**.
3. **One key, two names:** the music decides which name it uses.

If F♯ and G♭ both look odd, check the key: the name follows the notes around it, the key stays the same.

HOW TO

Three checks before you read a new line

1. **The clefs:** which staff is treble, which is bass?
2. **The landmarks:** find middle C, treble G and bass F, and read the other notes from them.
3. **The accidentals:** mark each sharp, flat or natural, and see where its bar ends.

THINK OF IT Like reading a map: find the big landmarks first, then the streets around them. A note far from any landmark is the one most often misread.